HEGEL - DIALECTICAL METHOD AND ABSOLUTE IDEALISM

KANT'S FIXED OPPOSITIONS -> DETERMINATE NEGATION AND SUBLATION -> BEING, NOTHING, BECOMING -> CONCRETE UNIVERSAL -> LOGIC, NATURE, SPIRIT -> SUBSTANCE AS SUBJECT -> AGAINST THE NOUMENON -> RECOGNITION AND ALIENATION -> THE LOGIC-NATURE SEAM -> FREEDOM IN HISTORY -> ANSWER SPINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW
● SUBORDINATE EXTRA
● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE - Pending user review - repaired in place for Topic 05 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 ONE CLAIM, TWO PRINTED LIMBS: METHOD AND ABSOLUTE

DIALECTICAL METHOD
ABSOLUTE IDEALISM
IMMANENT DEVELOPMENT
NOT TWO TOPICS
SYLLABUS ITEM 5
METHOD IS THE ABSOLUTE'S LIFE

A FINITE DETERMINATION TAKEN AS COMPLETE DESTROYS ITSELF BY ITS OWN CLAIM

LIMB 1 - THE MECHANISM: abstract immediacy, determinate negation, sublation
→
LIMB 2 - THE RESULT: nature and finite spirit as moments of a developing whole
→
THE LINK: the Absolute is the completed movement of the method itself

PRINTED CLAUSE

- Hegel : Dialectical Method; Absolute Idealism (Paper I, Section A, item 5).
- Two limbs, one claim: the mechanism seen from the side of the result.

MECHANISM IN FOUR BEATS

- Abstract immediacy (Unmittelbarkeit): a determination claims to need nothing else.
- Determinate negation (bestimmte Negation): the defect names the successor.
- Sublation (Aufhebung): cancel the isolation, preserve the content, raise both.

RESULT IN ONE SENTENCE

- Thought, nature and finite spirit are intelligible only within a self-developing rational whole.
- Nature and finite minds are real but not self-sufficient: they are moments.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The method is not applied to the Absolute from outside; the Absolute is the completed movement of the method.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hegel's Absolute is not a thing behind the world but the world grasped as a self-developing rational whole.

01

STAGE 01 ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY: WHICH TEXT SAYS WHAT

1770-1831
PHENOMENOLOGY 1807
SCIENCE OF LOGIC 1812-16
ENCYCLOPAEDIA 1817
PHILOSOPHY OF RIGHT 1820/21
LECTURES ARE POSTHUMOUS

1807 PHENOMENOLOGY OF SPIRIT - Preface P17 substance and subject; P20 the True is the Whole; Ch. IV A and IV B
→
1812-16 SCIENCE OF LOGIC - Being, Nothing, Becoming; determinate negation; the Concept
→
1817 ENCYCLOPAEDIA - S209 cunning of reason; S244 free release; S247 otherness; S250 impotence of nature
→
1820/21 PHILOSOPHY OF RIGHT - the actuality formula and the owl of Minerva
→
1837/1840 HISTORY LECTURES edited by Gans and by Karl Hegel from student transcripts

LIFE, ONLY WHERE IT PREVENTS ANACHRONISM

- Born Stuttgart 1770; Tuebingen Stift with Schelling and Hoelderlin; Jena 1801; professor 1805.
- Phenomenology completed 13 October 1807, the day Napoleon's armies captured Jena.
- Nuernberg Gymnasium 1808-16; Heidelberg 1816; Berlin 1818; died 1831.

CITATION RULE

- Encyclopaedia by S number - edition-invariant. Phenomenology by Preface paragraph or chapter.
- Science of Logic by division; Philosophy of Right by its Preface.

PROVENANCE CAUTIONS

- The history and aesthetics lectures are posthumously edited student transcripts: say 'in the lectures'.
- Thesis-antithesis-synthesis runs through Fichte and was popularised by Chalybaeus in 1837.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Getting the edition wrong is the fastest way to lose a mark that had already been earned.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Two of the most quoted Hegelian formulas belong to lectures Hegel never published, and saying so is itself evidence of study.

02

STAGE 02 KANT'S RESIDUAL OPPOSITIONS AND IMMANENT CRITIQUE

IMMANENT CRITIQUE
FIXED OPPOSITIONS
THOUGHT IS CONSTITUTIVE
NO EXTERNAL STANDARD
SPIRIT IS NOT A GHOST
THE PREMISE IS KANT'S

WHAT HEGEL KEEPS

- Thought is constitutive, not a passive mirror of a ready-made reality.
- Concede this before criticising, or the criticism reads as external.

WHAT HE REFUSES

- Sensibility against understanding: an artificial division that must then be artificially rejoined.
- Appearance against the thing in itself: a permanent unknowable remainder.
- Finite against unconditioned, and is against ought.

WHY THE ARGUMENT MUST BE INTERNAL

- After Kant no external standard is available - that was Kant's own point against dogmatism.
- You specified a determinate limit; specifying it is an act of thought; and thought that determinately excludes has already related.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Spirit is rational self-consciousness realised in culture and institutions, and Hegel tries to say so without hypostatising a super-subject.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The fence is drawn from inside the field, and drawing it is already an act of the thought it was meant to fence off.

03

STAGE 03 THE DIALECTICAL METHOD IN FOUR STATED STEPS

ABSTRACT IMMEDIACY
IMMANENT EXAMINATION
DETERMINATE NEGATION
SUBLATION
DEMONSTRATE, DO NOT ANNOUNCE
NOT AN EXTERNAL RECIPE

STEP 1 ABSTRACT IMMEDIACY - a determination is taken as self-standing, needing nothing else
→
STEP 2 IMMANENT EXAMINATION - hold it to its own claim; a specific insufficiency appears
→
STEP 3 DETERMINATE NEGATION - negation of this content, so the defect names the successor
→
STEP 4 SUBLATION - cancel the isolation, preserve the content, raise both into a mediated unity

WHY DETERMINATE IS LOAD-BEARING

- An indeterminate negation of X yields only not-X, that is, everything else whatever.
- Because the negation is of this content, the successor must answer this defect.

THE TEST FOR YOUR OWN SCRIPT

- Can you say why the successor had to be that one and not another?
- If not, you have written a triad rather than a dialectic.

WHAT EACH SENSE OF AUFHEBUNG DOES

- Drop cancel and nothing has been criticised; drop raise and two positions merely draw.
- Drop preserve and the cumulative history of philosophy is destroyed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Not every passage has a visible three-beat form, and the transition must be demonstrated in each case.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The successor is written by the precise shape of the predecessor's failure, which is why the method needs no external criterion.

04

STAGE 04 CONTRADICTION, MEDIATION AND THE TRIAD'S PROVENANCE

WIDERSPRUCH
VERMITTLUNG
NEGATION OF THE NEGATION
NOT EX FALSO
CHALYBAEUS 1837
FICHTE, NOT HEGEL

CONTRADICTION, QUALIFIED

- The self-opposition of a finite determination absolutised beyond its proper limits.
- Not the assertion of P and not-P in the same respect, and not a licence for ex falso quodlibet.
- Whether Hegel also commits himself to ontological contradiction remains contested.

MEDIATION AND RETURN

- A term becomes fully itself through its relation to what it initially excluded.
- The negation of the negation yields a new immediacy containing the route, not the untouched start.

THE PROVENANCE CLAUSE

- Thesis-antithesis-synthesis is not Hegel's general schema; it runs through Fichte and was popularised by Chalybaeus in 1837.
- No verified 2018-2025 Paper I question prints the formula.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — If the triadic label is used as shorthand, flag the provenance and immediately reconstruct the immanent transition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hegel's contradiction is a tension of opposed determinations inside a concept, not a truth-functional conjunction that would explode logic.

05

STAGE 05 BEING, NOTHING AND BECOMING: THE WORKED CASE

PURE BEING
PURE NOTHING
BECOMING
PRESUPPOSITIONLESS START
LOGICAL, NOT TEMPORAL
FIRST CONCRETE CATEGORY

PURE BEING (Sein) - being without further determination: no quality, no quantity, no relation
→
INDISTINGUISHABLE FROM PURE NOTHING (Nichts) - any separating mark would itself be a determination
→
BECOMING (Werden) - coming-to-be and ceasing-to-be, the truth of their inseparability
→
BEING AND NOTHING SURVIVE AS MOMENTS - the first category with genuine content

WHY THE LOGIC BEGINS HERE

- The system claims to presuppose nothing, so it must begin from a determination with no content.
- The choice of pure being is forced by that claim, not arbitrary.

FOUR MISREADINGS BLOCKED

- Nothing is not a kind of being: both are equally indeterminate.
- There is no before: the transition is logical, not a creation story.
- Becoming is not a compromise, and the triad does not prove the whole system.

THE HONEST LIMIT

- A critic may grant indistinguishability and still deny that it licenses a transition.
- The passage exhibits the method; each later transition carries its own burden of demonstration.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Forward link: Becoming leads to determinate being (Dasein), which is not actuality (Wirklichkeit) and so protects the rational-actual formula.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Two blanks that cannot be told apart, and one movement that is the difference between them.

06

STAGE 06 ABSTRACT SHADOW AGAINST THE CONCRETE UNIVERSAL

UNITY BY OMISSION
UNITY BY SELF-DIFFERENTIATION
THE TRUE IS THE WHOLE
THE WHOLE IS A RESULT
INTERNAL RELATIONS
BRADLEY, NOT HEGEL

THE ABSTRACT UNIVERSAL

- A genus reached by deleting differences: a thin residue that is nowhere actual.
- Its unity is purchased by omission, so it cannot explain what it deleted.

THE CONCRETE UNIVERSAL

- It retains and organises its own differentiations within itself.
- The differences are what the universal does, not the price paid for it.

THE QUOTATION IN FULL

- The True is the Whole. But the Whole is nothing other than the essence completing itself through its development.
- Phenomenology of Spirit, Preface paragraph 20 - never quote the first clause alone.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Internal relations follow as a corollary, and Moore's and Russell's immediate target was often the British neo-Hegelian Bradley.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A universal that must delete its differences to be a universal has already confessed that it is the wrong kind.

07

STAGE 07 THE CONCEPT'S THREE MOMENTS AND IDENTITY-IN-DIFFERENCE

ALLGEMEINHEIT
BESONDERHEIT
EINZELHEIT
IDENTITY-IN-DIFFERENCE
LOGICAL REGISTER ONLY
NOT A MENTAL IMAGE

MOMENT	FUNCTION	WHAT GOES WRONG WITHOUT IT
UNIVERSALITY (Allgemeinheit)	the common intelligible structure	particularity has nothing to be a differentiation of
PARTICULARITY (Besonderheit)	the universal differentiating itself into determinate forms	the universal reverts to a shadow reached by subtraction
INDIVIDUALITY (Einzelheit)	the concrete unity in which universal and particular are realised together	the account stops short of where both are actual at once

IDENTITY-IN-DIFFERENCE

- Genuine identity is maintained through determinate difference, not by erasing it.
- The 1801 Difference essay formula is rendered variously; paraphrase unless an edition is named.
- It is never numerical identity between opposites.

REGISTER WARNING

- The triad belongs primarily to the logical register.
- Illustrate it with a state or a period if you wish, but do not identify it with them.

STANDING OBJECTION

- If each finite item is true only as a moment, individuality seems dissolved.
- Reply: sublation preserves determinate difference. Residual: it must be shown, not presumed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Universality is actual only through particularisation and concrete individuality, which is why the concrete universal cannot hover above particulars.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Concept is not a private image or an extensional class but a structure that produces the very differences it unifies.

08

STAGE 08 BAD INFINITE, TRUE INFINITE AND THE THREE DOMAINS

SCHLECHTE UNENDLICHKEIT
TRUE INFINITE
LOGIC
NATURE
SPIRIT
THE FINITE IS REAL

AN INFINITE DEFINED BY EXCLUDING THE FINITE IS BORDERED BY IT AND SO IS FINITE

LOGIC - the Idea in itself: Being, Essence, Concept
→
NATURE - the Idea in the form of otherness (Enc. S247): space, time, matter, organisms
→
SPIRIT - the Idea returned to itself: subjective, objective, absolute

THE ARGUMENT IN FIVE STEPS

- Suppose the infinite is what lies beyond the finite; then the finite is its border.
- To have a border is to be limited, so an infinite reached by exclusion is finite.
- The genuine infinite therefore includes finite self-limitation and return.

WHAT FOLLOWS FOR THE ABSOLUTE

- The Absolute is not one object over against finite objects.
- Any answer that makes it one has produced a bad infinite.
- The finite is real as a moment, neither annihilated nor left outside.

TWO STANDING CAUTIONS

- The Phenomenology is a distinct itinerary, not the Encyclopaedia's Spirit division.
- Each domain develops immanently, but not by repeating one identical triad.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Philosophy is the highest form of Absolute Spirit, which does not make any finite philosopher omniscient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: An infinite that excludes the finite has been fenced in by it, so the Absolute must go out into its other and return.

09

STAGE 09 THE THREE FORMS OF SPIRIT AT OWNED DEPTH

SUBJECTIVE SPIRIT
OBJECTIVE SPIRIT
ABSOLUTE SPIRIT
SITTLICHKEIT
ORIENTATION NOT ENDORSEMENT
SAME CONTENT, THREE FORMS

THE BOUNDED LADDER FOR 2023

- Abstract right, then morality, then ethical life (Sittlichkeit).
- Family gives immediate ethical unity; civil society organises differentiated needs, work and legal dependence.
- The constitutional state claims to integrate particular and universal freedom.

ART, RELIGION, PHILOSOPHY

- The same content in sensuous form, in representation (Vorstellung) and in the concept (Begriff).
- This is why 'Absolute Spirit is God' is not a Hegelian formula in that bald form.

SCOPE CONTROL

- Orientation, not endorsement of every existing state.
- Detailed political philosophy and the full philosophies of art and religion remain optional enrichment.
- Swapping the family and civil-society descriptions is a quick way to lose an earned mark.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Objective Spirit is where freedom stops being a demand and becomes an institutional arrangement that can be assessed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ethical life is admitted here only because the history question needs somewhere for freedom to land, and no further.

10

STAGE 10 SUBSTANCE AS SUBJECT AND THE ACTUALITY DISCRIMINATION

SUBSTANCE AND SUBJECT
SELF-RETURN
WIRKLICHKEIT
DASEIN
NOT A COSMIC PERSON
SPINOZA CORRECTED

WHAT SUBJECT ADDS

- Everything turns on grasping the True not only as Substance but equally as Subject (Preface 17).
- Active self-mediation: the Absolute differentiates itself and returns to itself in Spirit.
- Subject is a structure, never a psychological ego or a cosmic person.

THE WORD THAT DECIDES THE SENTENCE

- Actuality (Wirklichkeit) is the effective unity of essence and existence.
- Determinate existence (Dasein) is bare being-there, an early and still abstract category.
- A defective institution exists without being actual, which is what licenses criticism of it.

TWO TRAPS AND ONE RESIDUE

- The text says not only but equally: Spinoza is corrected, and admired, not dismissed.
- The distinction blocks 'whatever exists is right' but does not clear Hegel of the conservatism charge.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Four denials define Absolute Idealism: not anti-realism, not perceiver-dependence, not a second world, not a cosmic person.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nature and finite minds are real as a chapter is real, and no more self-explanatory than a chapter read outside its book.

11

STAGE 11 THREE PRONGS AGAINST THE NOUMENON AND THE VERDICT GRID

RELATIONAL LIMIT
EMPTY ABSTRACTION
FIXED DUALISM
LIMITING CONCEPT
2025 Q1(e)
2020 Q1(d)

PRONG OR READING	WHAT IS ARGUED	WHAT IT SETTLES
1 A DETERMINATELY KNOWN LIMIT IS RELATIONAL	to know something as a limit is to place it in a field and relate it to what it excludes	the boundary cannot be a wholly external contentless barrier
2 THE EMPTY IN-ITSELF IS AN ABSTRACTION	remove every determinate relation and the alleged pure in-itself says nothing	thought produced the abstraction it then treats as alien
3 FIXED DUALISM BLOCKS EXPLANATION	permanently external terms leave their relation unaccountable	mediation and identity-in-difference replace the wall
REIFIED TWO-WORLD READING	a second set of objects standing behind appearances	critique lands with full force
AFFECTION READING	things in themselves said to cause our sensations	critique lands: causality is restricted to appearances
STRICT LIMITING-CONCEPT READING	the negative noumenon restricts without describing	critique is weak: emptiness is the function, not a defect

RESULT, STATED PRECISELY

- Hegel rejects the thing in itself as a permanently unknowable explanatory remainder.
- What is in itself becomes intelligible through its relations and its development for itself.
- This is not omniscience, and the limit argument alone does not prove the completeness of the system.

THE 2020 DOCTRINE

- Appearance is neither an independent thing in itself nor a private mental illusion.
- It is a finite mediated manifestation of the Absolute: real as a moment, not ultimate as isolated.

OBJECTION AND RESIDUE

- If only the whole is fully true, individual reality seems dissolved.
- Reply: sublation preserves determinate content. Residual: critics question whether individuality survives.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Denying that there is a permanently external remainder and claiming acquaintance with a hidden object are different claims, and only the first is Hegel's.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A limit you can describe that precisely is already standing inside the field of thought that describes it.

12

STAGE 12 LORDSHIP AND BONDAGE: THE REVERSAL AND ITS LIMIT

RECOGNITION
LIFE-AND-DEATH STRUGGLE
ROLES ARE A RESULT
FEAR, SERVICE, LABOUR
BILDUNG
RECEPTION FIREWALL

TWO SELF-CONSCIOUSNESSES SEEK RECOGNITION FROM ANOTHER WHOSE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT WOULD COUNT
→
LIFE-AND-DEATH STRUGGLE - risking life proves one is more than a merely living thing
→
ASYMMETRIC ROLES EMERGE AS A RESULT when one submits rather than sustain the risk of death
→
THE REVERSAL - worthless recognition for the lord; fear, service and formative labour for the bondsman

THE LORD'S DOUBLE DEPENDENCE

- Recognition from a consciousness reduced to dependence is worth nothing.
- He no longer engages the world, so the bondsman's work mediates everything for him.

THE BONDSMAN'S ROUTE, IN ORDER

- Fear: the absolute melting-away of everything he had taken as fixed.
- Service: desire is checked and deferred rather than immediately consumed.
- Formative labour: a form is put into an object and persists there, so agency becomes durable.

LIMIT AND FIREWALL

- One-sided domination is destabilised; reciprocal recognition and freedom are not yet achieved.
- Marxist, Kojevian, feminist and anti-colonial receptions are transformations, not transcriptions.
- This is the phenomenological register; the Logic remains the primary account of the method.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Nothing external intervenes: the lord gets exactly what he demanded, and what he demanded is self-defeating once obtained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The lord wins the argument and loses the reason for having it, and no external judge was required to say so.

13

STAGE 13 STOICISM, SCEPTICISM AND THE UNHAPPY CONSCIOUSNESS

ABSTRACT AND EMPTY
PERFORMATIVE CONTRADICTION
ENTZWEIUNG
ANDACHT
ENTAEUSSERUNG
TRANSITION TO REASON

STOICISM - free on the throne or in chains, and therefore able to say only 'the true, the good'
→
SCEPTICISM - enacts negation and must assert that nothing can be asserted while living as a determinate individual
→
UNHAPPY CONSCIOUSNESS - the contradiction becomes conscious of itself: the Unchangeable against the Changeable
→
THE REVERSAL - complete renunciation removes the particular self that stood opposed, so the surrender is the achievement

THE FOUR MOMENTS

- Devotion (Andacht) at a shapeless beyond, with the self's own particularity felt as guilt.
- Desire and work whose achievement is attributed to the Unchangeable, so activity is alienated.
- Self-mortification through a mediator (Mittler): total externalisation (Entaeusserung).

THREE PRESUPPOSITIONS

- Shapes destroy themselves from within, and the philosopher only watches.
- Alienation is self-inflicted and therefore self-curable: the beyond is consciousness's own product.
- The sequence is logical, not chronological.

OBJECTIONS AND RESIDUALS

- Kierkegaard: the individual before God cannot be a moment of a system; the reply distinguishes levels rather than refuting.
- Theological critics: the account of religion is reductive; Hegel treats religion as Absolute Spirit in representational form.
- Analytic critics: literary description; the force is the performative contradiction, but the necessity is retrospective.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Feuerbach and Marx later transform this structure into distinct critiques of religious and material alienation, and must not be retrojected.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hegel identified something real here and resolved it too quickly, which is why both his heirs remain convincing.

14

STAGE 14 THE LOGIC-TO-NATURE SEAM AND ITS FOUR OBJECTIONS

ENC. S244
ENC. S247
ENC. S250
NOT TEMPORAL, NOT CAUSAL
SCHELLING
TRENDELENBURG

THE DILEMMA AND HEGEL'S TEXT

- If necessary, how can a category produce an existent? If not, presuppositionless self-grounding collapses at completion.
- S244: the Absolute Idea freely releases itself; S247: Nature is the Idea in the form of otherness.
- S250: the impotence of nature - it cannot hold fast to the Concept, hence contingency.

THE DEFENSIBLE READING

- Logical and structural: pure self-relating form has no content of its own, so it is its own externality.
- Release names this; it is not an event, and no particular natural fact is deduced.
- The 'deduced the planets' charge is a caricature contradicted by S250.

FOUR OBJECTIONS, FOUR RESIDUALS

- Schelling 1841-2: the system gives what must be, never that anything is - the strongest objection in the topic.
- Feuerbach 1839: creation ex nihilo renamed; the reply works only for those who grant that philosophy translates religion.
- Trendelenburg 1840: motion smuggled into static categories - and the objection generalises to the whole method.
- Category mistake: agency verbs applied to a concept, and the metaphor cannot be fully cashed out.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Read as structure the transition is coherent; read as demonstration it is not, because the necessity is intelligible only retrospectively.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A form that is nothing but self-relation is already outside itself, which is either the system's completion or its visible seam.

15

STAGE 15 DIALECTIC IN HISTORY: MECHANISM BEFORE SCHEMA

NORM THEN RESTRICTION
CONSCIOUSNESS OF FREEDOM
LIST DER VERNUNFT
ONE, SOME, ALL
EUROCENTRISM CAUTION
OWL OF MINERVA

MECHANISM FIRST - an embodied norm of freedom, an internal restriction, and a more adequate institution
→
ORIENTAL - one is free: the Persian and Chinese empires
→
GREEK AND ROMAN - some are free, citizens and not slaves: Athenian democracy and Roman law
→
GERMANIC-CHRISTIAN - all free in principle: the modern constitutional state as Hegel's claimed horizon
→
CUNNING OF REASON - Caesar and Napoleon effect transitions they do not fully comprehend (Enc. S209)

SOURCE STATUS, IN LINE ONE

- The philosophy of history survives as lectures edited posthumously by Gans in 1837 and Karl Hegel in 1840.
- Say 'in the lectures on the philosophy of history', never 'Hegel wrote'.

WHAT THE CLAIM IS AND IS NOT

- The development is in what a society understands freedom to require.
- It claims direction and intelligibility, not linearity and not causal determinism.

THE REQUIRED CRITICISM

- A dated Eurocentric hierarchy that treats European modernity as the telos.
- 'All are free' states a principle, not an achievement of Hegel's Europe.
- Popper: historicist narratives immunise themselves; reply: the Logic is not empirical prediction; residual: the owl of Minerva concedes retrospection.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The fatal error is offering the civilisation list as proof, when it is only an illustration of a mechanism stated first and criticised afterwards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A society that proclaims a freedom it withholds has already written its own crisis into its founding arrangements.

16

STAGE 16 PYQ ROUTES, COMPARISON AXES AND THE ANSWER SPINE

SIX OWNED PARTS
THREE ROUTED ELSEWHERE
FIX THE AXIS FIRST
CRITICISM, REPLY, RESIDUAL
GRADED VERDICT
PROVENANCE CLAUSE

2019 Q1(c) and 2022 Q3(b) - the method, and how it realises the Absolute
→
2021 Q2(a) - method, worked case, three domains, the Kantian reckoning, two named critics
→
2020 Q1(d) and 2025 Q1(e) - the mediated reality of appearance and the three prongs
→
2023 Q1(b) - mechanism, schema, cunning of reason, Eurocentrism caution
→
2018 Q2(b), 2023 Q1(d), 2024 Q2(a) - Hegel named, but owned by Topics 04, 10 and 03

THE UNIVERSAL ANSWER SPINE

- Fix the axis, then expound in numbered steps with a demonstrated transition and a text or S number.
- State the result or application, then the reckoning with the named rival on that same axis.
- Close with one named critic, a reply, a residual, and a verdict graded to the mark value.

COMPARISON AXES

- Kant, Marx and Kierkegaard: thing-in-itself, ultimate reality, dialectic, freedom, truth.
- Berkeley (2024): what is ultimate - a finite perceiving mind and its ideas, or a self-developing whole.

TEN-LINE TRAP SHEET

- Wirklichkeit is not Dasein; Geist is not a ghost; Hegel is not Berkeley; Marx transforms rather than substitutes.
- The triad is later shorthand; the history lectures are transcripts; S250 forbids deducing natural particulars.
- The roles of lord and bondsman are a result, and the Phenomenology is not the Encyclopaedia's Spirit division.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A criticism without a reply, or a reply without a residual, forfeits the assessment mark however accurate the exposition was.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hegel's permanent achievement is that intelligibility is immanent and mediated; his permanent cost is that necessity is visible only in retrospect.

E

EXTRA OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT: FOUR INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

METAPHYSICAL OR NOT
REAL CONTRADICTION
RECOGNITION THEORY
HEGEL AND STRAWSON

SECOND-ORDER DISPUTES

- Is the Absolute a metaphysical Spirit or the self-articulating intelligibility of thought, practice and history?
- Does dialectical contradiction mean real contradictions, or the self-instability of one-sided categories?

EXTENSIONS AND BRIDGES

- Is recognition central to Hegelian freedom, or one dramatic episode of the Phenomenology?
- Hegel and Strawson attack the same target by different methods and reach different positive positions.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This enrichment stage is unnecessary for a competent core answer and must never be used to repair missing core content.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels